

Product Requirements Document (PRD): SpendWise Mobile Expense Tracker (Version 1.0)

1. Product Overview

SpendWise is a cross-platform mobile application designed to empower individuals, families, and small business owners to effortlessly track, categorize, and gain deep insights into their financial transactions. The app aims to solve the problem of manual, scattered, and often inaccurate expense tracking by providing a seamless, secure, and automated mobile-first solution. Its primary value proposition is transforming raw spending data into actionable financial awareness and control.

2. Goals & Objectives

The primary goals of the SpendWise application are to:

- **Ease of Use:** Enable users to log an expense in under 5 seconds.
- **Financial Awareness:** Provide clear, intuitive visualizations that help users understand their spending habits immediately.
- **Budget Control:** Equip users with tools to set, monitor, and stay within their defined budgets.
- **Security:** Ensure all user financial data is encrypted and protected with industry-standard authentication methods.
- **Scalability:** Design the system to reliably support up to 1 million active users with high performance.

3. User Personas

Persona	Description	Core Needs
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College Student: Avrojit	A 20-year-old student living away from home with a fixed monthly allowance. He often spends quickly on food and social activities and needs help staying within budget until the next allowance deposit.	Needs simple, fast expense logging (P0) and real-time alerts when approaching budget limits (P0).
Working Professional: Naaz	A 35-year-old marketing manager who manages household bills, subscriptions, and discretionary spending. She needs to separate business expenses from personal finances for tax purposes.	Requires recurring expense automation (P1), reliable multi-device sync (P1), and secure login (P0).
Small Business Owner: Ela	A 48-year-old owner of a small carpentry shop. He needs accurate, exportable records of operational expenses (supplies, utilities) and cash flow for quarterly tax filings and managing business health.	Must have detailed categorization and tagging (P0), robust export functionality (P0/P1), and a clear dashboard summary (P0).

4. User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria (Given-When-Then)
US-01	As a user, I want to add an expense quickly so that I can track daily spending without disruption.	P0	Given I am on the home screen, When I tap the "Add Expense" button and input an amount and category, Then the expense is saved instantly and appears in my daily transactions list.
US-02	As a Working Professional, I want to securely log into the app using my fingerprint	P0	Given I have enabled biometric login, When I open the app, Then I am prompted for my fingerprint/face ID, and

	so that my financial data is protected.		upon success, I am granted access to the app.
US-03	As a Small Business Owner, I want to generate a PDF report for a selected date range so that I can send it to my bookkeeper for tax preparation.	P0	Given I have selected the past quarter in the Reporting section, When I tap 'Export as PDF', Then a PDF document containing categorized transactions and totals is generated and accessible via the system share menu.
US-04	As a user, I want to set a maximum monthly budget for the 'Entertainment' category so that I can control my discretionary spending.	P0	Given I have navigated to the Budget section, When I set the 'Entertainment' budget to \$200, Then the budget is saved, and the home dashboard displays the limit and my current spending against it.
US-05	As a College Student, I want to receive a notification when I spend 90% of my 'Food' budget so that I stop overspending.	P1	Given my 'Food' budget is active and notifications are enabled, When my accumulated expenses in 'Food' reach 90% of the limit, Then a push notification alert is immediately triggered on my mobile device.
US-06	As a user, I want to view a visual chart of my spending over the last 6 months so that I can identify trends and areas for saving.	P1	Given I am in the Analytics section, When I select the '6-Month Trend' view, Then a line graph showing total monthly expenditure for the last six months is displayed.
US-07	As a Working Professional, I want to mark an expense as 'Recurring' (e.g., rent) so that it is logged	P1	Given I am adding a new expense, When I set the recurrence to 'Monthly' and save, Then the expense is automatically logged on the same date each subsequent month until cancelled.

	automatically every month.		
US-08	As a user, I want to edit a mistakenly entered expense so that my records are accurate.	P0	Given I have located the incorrect transaction, When I tap 'Edit' and change the amount from \$50 to \$5.00, Then the change is saved, and all associated summaries/budgets are recalculated instantly.
US-09	As a user, I want to delete old, irrelevant transactions so that my data is clean and manageable.	P0	Given I am viewing a transaction's details, When I tap the 'Delete' button and confirm the action, Then the transaction is permanently removed from the database and my reports.
US-10	As a user, I want a multi-factor authentication (MFA) option upon login so that my account is highly secure even if my password is stolen.	P0	Given I enter my correct password, When I select 'Login with OTP', Then a one-time passcode is sent to my verified email/phone number, and I must enter it to gain access.
US-11	As a Small Business Owner, I want a dashboard summary showing current cash flow so that I can quickly assess the health of my business.	P0	Given I log into the app, When the dashboard loads, Then it displays a card summary of 'Total Income', 'Total Expenses', and 'Net Flow' for the current month.

:" User Story IDs

What are IDs (e.g., US-01)?

- **US** stands for *User Story*.
- The number (01, 02, 03...) is a sequential identifier.
- Together, IDs like US-01 uniquely label each user story in the PRD.

Why use IDs?

- **Traceability:** Makes it easy to link stories to acceptance criteria, test cases, and features.
- **Organization:** Helps reference stories quickly in discussions or tools like Jira/Trello.
- **Clarity:** Instead of saying "the student expense entry story," you can simply say "US-01."

Example in this PRD:

- **US-01:** *As a student, I want to add expenses quickly so that I can track daily spending.*
- **US-02:** *As a professional, I want to set monthly budgets so that I can control overspending.*
- **US-03:** *As a business owner, I want to export expense reports so that I can file taxes easily.*

5. Features List with Priority Labels

Priority	Feature	Description
P0 (Must-have)	Core Expense Logging	Manual entry and automatic OCR/camera scan functionality for quick expense capture.
P0 (Must-have)	Categorization & Tagging	User-definable categories and tags to organize expenses (e.g., Personal, Business).
P0 (Must-have)	Budget Setting & Tracking	Ability to create and monitor category-specific monthly budgets.
P0 (Must-have)	Reporting & Export	Generate transaction lists, summaries, and export data as CSV and PDF files.

P0 (Must-have)	Secure Login	Authentication via Email/Password, OTP, and Biometrics (Fingerprint/Face ID).
P1 (Important)	Budget Notifications	Push alerts when spending reaches a pre-set threshold (e.g., 80% or 90%).
P1 (Important)	Recurring Expense Automation	Automatic logging of subscriptions or fixed bills on a set schedule.
P1 (Important)	Multi-Device Synchronization	Real-time data sync across all authorized devices (iOS and Android).
P1 (Important)	Data Visualizations	Dashboard summaries, line/bar charts to show spending trends over time.
P2 (Nice-to-have)	AI Insights	Automated suggestions for reducing spending or identifying unusual expenses.
P2 (Nice-to-have)	Gamified Savings Challenges	Features like 'No Spend Days' or 'Savings Streak' to encourage responsible spending.
P2 (Nice-to-have)	Social Sharing (Read-only)	Ability to share aggregated, non-sensitive financial summaries (e.g., "I saved \$100 this month") with friends.

6. Functional Requirements (FR)

The system must perform the following actions:

1. **FR-01: CRUD Operations:** The app must allow users to **Create** (log), **Read** (view), **Update** (edit), and **Delete** (remove) any transaction, category, or budget record.
2. **FR-02: Budget Alerts:** The system must trigger push notifications when a user-defined spending threshold (e.g., 80%) for a category budget is reached.

3. **FR-03: Export Functionality:** The system must generate and allow users to download or share expense reports in CSV and PDF formats, filtered by date, category, and tags.
4. **FR-04: Secure Login:** The app must support secure authentication methods including password, One-Time Passcode (OTP), and platform-native biometric recognition (Face ID/Touch ID).
5. **FR-05: Dashboard Summaries:** The home dashboard must provide a summarized view of the user's financial status, including month-to-date spending, remaining budget, and transaction totals.

7. Non-Functional Requirements (NFR)

The system must satisfy the following quality attributes:

1. **NFR-01: Mobile-First Design:** The application must be optimized for a smooth, intuitive experience on both iOS and Android mobile devices, adhering to native UX guidelines.
2. **NFR-02: Security (Encryption):** All data, both in transit (using HTTPS/TLS) and at rest (stored on servers), must be encrypted using AES-256 or equivalent standards.
3. **NFR-03: Performance:** The app must load the main dashboard screen in under **2 seconds** on all supported mid-range and high-end mobile devices.
4. **NFR-04: Scalability:** The backend architecture must be capable of supporting **1 million** concurrently active users without degrading performance or reliability.
5. **NFR-05: Uptime:** The service must maintain an annual uptime of **99.9%** (less than 8.76 hours of planned or unplanned downtime per year).

8. Out of Scope (Version 1.0)

The following features are explicitly excluded from the MVP launch:

- **Investment Tracking:** Integration or tracking of stocks, mutual funds, or cryptocurrency portfolios.
- **Payroll Management:** Features related to salary calculations, generating pay stubs, or employee expense reports.
- **Loan/Credit Card Integration:** Automatic syncing with banking or credit card institutions (manual entry is the focus).

9. Success Metrics (Quantifiable Measures)

These metrics will determine if the product has met its goals and can be considered a success after 6 months:

Metric	Target	Focus Area	"Done" Indicator
Daily Expense Logging %	70%	Adoption & Usage	High, sustained daily engagement.
Budget Adoption %	50%	Feature Usage	Core budgeting feature is being utilized.
90-Day Retention Rate	40%	Retention	Long-term user stickiness and value delivery.
Quarterly Report Exports %	25%	Feature Value	Users are relying on the app for serious financial analysis/tax needs.
App Store Rating	≥ 4.5	Quality & Satisfaction	High user satisfaction with the overall experience.

10. Timeline (6 Months)

Phase	Duration	Focus / Deliverables
Phase 1: Foundation & Design	Month 1	Market research, detailed UI/UX design, architecture finalization, full PRD sign-off.
Phase 2: Core Development (P0)	Month 2 – Month 3	Development and unit testing of all P0 features (CRUD, Secure Login, Basic Reporting, Core Logging).

Phase 3: Stabilization & Testing	Month 4	Internal QA and External Beta Testing (100–500 users). Bug fixes and feedback iteration.
Phase 4: Launch Preparation	Month 5	Final polish, deployment setup, full launch with all P0 and key P1 features (Budget Notifications, Data Visualizations).
Phase 5: Iteration	Month 6+	Continuous improvement, development and release of P2 features (AI Insights, Gamification).

11. BRD vs. PRD Comparison Note

The Business Requirements Document (BRD) and the Product Requirements Document (PRD) serve distinct, sequential purposes in the project lifecycle. They are often confused but describe different scopes of requirements.

Aspect	BRD (Business Requirements Document)	PRD (Product Requirements Document)
Purpose	Defines the <i>why</i> —the high-level business goals, scope, and ultimate business value. Focuses on the problem to be solved and the ROI.	Defines the <i>what</i> and the <i>how</i> —the detailed features, functionality, and user experience necessary to solve the problem.
Ownership	Primarily owned by the Business Analyst or Project Sponsor.	Primarily owned by the Product Manager .
Timing in Project Lifecycle	Created first, during the project initiation and planning phase.	Created after BRD approval, during the product design and development phases.
Typical Structure/Sections	Business goals, project scope, stakeholders, high-level business process flow, and financial justification.	User personas, user stories, detailed functional/non-functional

		requirements, features list, and success metrics.
Use Cases	Used to secure executive funding and stakeholder alignment on the business case.	Used to guide Engineering, Design, and QA teams during implementation and testing.